

Copperleaf Kitchens Operational Casebook

Compiled for Agentic RAG and Hybrid Search Optimization

This casebook presents a curated set of operational incidents, each referencing cross-manual policies (EH, FS, SP, WM, BO, CP) to support comprehensive retrieval and decision-making.

Case 001

Case ID	FS-2025-001
Priority	Critical
Affected Branch	Downtown Toronto
Departments Involved	Kitchen, Procurement, Quality Assurance
Scenario	Received shipment of raw chicken with off-odor and slimy texture from approved supplier. Suspected contamination due to temperature abuse during transit.
Risk Assessment	High risk of foodborne illness (Salmonella, Campylobacter). Potential for cross-contamination in kitchen. Regulatory non-compliance.
Applicable Policy IDs	FS-01, FS-07, SP-02, EH-03, BO-05
Immediate Actions	- Quarantine entire shipment. - Notify supplier and issue stop-use order. - Document defects with photos and logs. - Dispose of affected product per FS waste protocol.
Long-Term Preventive Actions	- Implement strict receiving temperature checks. - Supplier audit and performance review. - Enhance cold chain monitoring with IoT sensors. - Train staff on rejection criteria.
Related Documents	Supplier Quality Agreement, Food Safety Manual, Receiving Log Template
Keywords	food contamination, supplier failure, cold chain, temperature abuse, quarantine

Case 002

Case ID	EH-2025-002
Priority	High
Affected Branch	Vancouver
Departments Involved	Facilities, Kitchen, Management
Scenario	Routine health inspection found improper storage of cleaning chemicals near food prep area and lack of dated labels on prepared foods.
Risk Assessment	Medium risk – chemical contamination potential, cross-contamination, regulatory penalties, reputational damage.
Applicable Policy IDs	EH-02, FS-10, SP-05, BO-03, WM-06
Immediate Actions	• Relocate chemicals to designated storage. • Discard any potentially contaminated food. • Implement labeling system immediately. • Conduct staff training on chemical safety.
Long-Term Preventive Actions	• Redesign storage layout with clear separation. • Develop labeling SOP and audit checklist. • Schedule monthly internal inspections. • Integrate health inspection findings into training.
Related Documents	Health Inspection Report, Chemical Safety Data Sheets, Food Labeling Guide
Keywords	health inspection, chemical storage, labeling, compliance, cross-contamination

Case 003

Case ID	SP-2025-003
Priority	Critical
Affected Branch	Calgary
Departments Involved	Kitchen, Service, Maintenance
Scenario	Power outage during lunch rush. All electronic POS systems and kitchen equipment (ovens, fridges) non-operational. Backup generator failed to start.
Risk Assessment	High – food safety due to temperature rise, service disruption, loss of revenue, customer dissatisfaction.
Applicable Policy IDs	SP-01, FS-03, EH-04, BO-07, CP-02
Immediate Actions	• Switch to manual operations (paper orders, cash only). • Monitor fridge/freezer temperatures. • Close kitchen if unsafe; communicate to customers. • Contact utility and emergency generator service.
Long-Term Preventive Actions	• Upgrade backup generator and test regularly. • Develop power loss contingency plan. • Install temperature sensors with alerts. • Train staff on manual processes.
Related Documents	Emergency Procedure Manual, Generator Maintenance Log, Temperature Monitoring Plan
Keywords	power outage, equipment failure, contingency plan, temperature monitoring, manual operations

Case 004

Case ID	WM-2025-004
Priority	Medium
Affected Branch	Ottawa
Departments Involved	Kitchen, Facilities, Administration
Scenario	Waste audit revealed that recyclable materials (cardboard, plastics) were being disposed of in general waste bins, and organic waste was not separated properly.
Risk Assessment	Low-medium – regulatory fines for non-compliance, environmental impact, increased disposal costs.
Applicable Policy IDs	WM-01, WM-03, EH-05, FS-08, BO-04
Immediate Actions	• Re-train staff on proper waste segregation. • Place clear signage on bins. • Conduct spot checks. • Correct any mislabeled waste.
Long-Term Preventive Actions	• Implement waste segregation SOP. • Schedule regular waste audits. • Engage certified waste management vendor. • Integrate environmental goals into KPI.
Related Documents	Waste Management Plan, Recycling Guidelines, Vendor Contract
Keywords	waste segregation, recycling, compliance, environmental, organic waste

Case 005

Case ID	BO-2025-005
Priority	High
Affected Branch	Montreal
Departments Involved	Finance, Kitchen, HR, Security
Scenario	Employee observed pocketing cash from register during shift. Internal audit revealed minor discrepancies over past month.
Risk Assessment	Medium – financial loss, legal action, reputational impact, employee morale.
Applicable Policy IDs	BO-01, BO-02, SP-04, EH-06, CP-03
Immediate Actions	- Suspended employee pending investigation. - Conduct full cash reconciliation. - Review surveillance footage. - Notify HR and legal.
Long-Term Preventive Actions	- Implement dual-cash handling procedures. - Install additional CCTV coverage. - Regular surprise audits. - Enhance ethics training.
Related Documents	Cash Handling Policy, Employee Handbook, Audit Report
Keywords	employee misconduct, theft, cash handling, internal audit, surveillance

Case 006

Case ID	CP-2025-006
Priority	Critical
Affected Branch	Toronto Pearson
Departments Involved	Kitchen, Service, Legal, PR
Scenario	Customer experienced allergic reaction (peanuts) after ordering a dish that was supposed to be allergen-free. Menu did not list peanut traces.
Risk Assessment	High – health risk, legal liability, reputational damage, regulatory action.
Applicable Policy IDs	CP-01, FS-04, EH-07, SP-06, BO-08
Immediate Actions	• Provide medical assistance and call emergency services. • Preserve food sample and incident details. • Notify insurance and legal. • Remove dish from menu pending investigation.
Long-Term Preventive Actions	• Enhance allergen training and labeling. • Source ingredients with allergen declarations. • Implement allergen information system. • Review menu descriptions.
Related Documents	Allergen Management Policy, Incident Report, Menu Review Guide
Keywords	allergen, allergic reaction, customer complaint, legal liability, menu labeling

Case 007

Case ID	FS-2025-007
Priority	High
Affected Branch	Edmonton
Departments Involved	Kitchen, Maintenance, Procurement
Scenario	Walk-in cooler compressor failed, causing temperature to rise to 15°C for over 4 hours. Stored dairy and meat products may be compromised.
Risk Assessment	High – spoilage, foodborne illness if used, financial loss from discarding stock.
Applicable Policy IDs	FS-02, FS-05, SP-03, EH-08, WM-02
Immediate Actions	- Relocate perishables to backup storage. - Check temperatures and discard affected items. - Arrange urgent repair. - Document loss and inform management.
Long-Term Preventive Actions	- Implement preventive maintenance schedule. - Install temperature alarms. - Have backup refrigeration arrangement. - Train staff on emergency protocols.
Related Documents	Equipment Maintenance Log, Temperature Monitoring Policy, Food Disposal Record
Keywords	equipment failure, cold storage, temperature alarm, spoilage, food waste

Case 008

Case ID	EH-2025-008
Priority	High
Affected Branch	Halifax
Departments Involved	Kitchen, Facilities, Management
Scenario	Pest control inspection found cockroach activity near dishwashing area and behind equipment. Pest control records were outdated.
Risk Assessment	High – health code violation, food contamination risk, reputational damage, closure risk.
Applicable Policy IDs	EH-01, FS-06, SP-07, WM-04, BO-09
Immediate Actions	• Close affected area for deep cleaning. • Schedule emergency pest control treatment. • Dispose of contaminated food. • Notify health inspector if required.
Long-Term Preventive Actions	• Establish monthly pest control contracts. • Implement strict sanitation schedules. • Seal entry points. • Train staff on pest sign reporting.
Related Documents	Pest Control Report, Sanitation SOP, Health Code Compliance Guide
Keywords	pest infestation, cockroach, sanitation, health code, pest control

Case 009

Case ID	SP-2025-009
Priority	Medium
Affected Branch	Quebec City
Departments Involved	Procurement, Kitchen, Management
Scenario	Primary supplier of fresh produce notified of a strike, causing indefinite shortage. Need to source alternative suppliers urgently.
Risk Assessment	Medium – menu disruption, increased costs, potential quality issues, customer dissatisfaction.
Applicable Policy IDs	SP-08, FS-09, BO-06, WM-05, CP-04
Immediate Actions	• Activate emergency supplier list. • Negotiate temporary contracts. • Adjust menu based on available ingredients. • Communicate with branches.
Long-Term Preventive Actions	• Diversify supplier base. • Maintain strategic buffer stock. • Develop supplier risk assessment. • Create contingency procurement plan.
Related Documents	Supplier List, Emergency Procurement Plan, Menu Engineering Guide
Keywords	supplier shortage, strike, emergency procurement, menu adaptation, contingency plan

Case 010

Case ID	WM-2025-010
Priority	Low
Affected Branch	Winnipeg
Departments Involved	Kitchen, Facilities, Administration
Scenario	Recycling bins were consistently contaminated with food waste, leading to rejection by waste hauler and extra fees.
Risk Assessment	Low – increased costs, potential regulatory warning, environmental impact.
Applicable Policy IDs	WM-02, EH-09, FS-11, SP-09, BO-10
Immediate Actions	• Re-train staff on recycling rules. • Add visual guides above bins. • Conduct weekly contamination audits. • Penalize repeated non-compliance.
Long-Term Preventive Actions	• Implement waste sorting incentives. • Upgrade bins with clear labels. • Partner with waste hauler for education. • Incorporate waste metrics into performance reviews.
Related Documents	Recycling Program Guide, Waste Audit Checklist, Staff Training Manual
Keywords	recycling contamination, waste management, staff training, contamination, penalties

Case 011

Case ID	BO-2025-011
Priority	Medium
Affected Branch	Saskatoon
Departments Involved	Finance, Service, Management
Scenario	Daily cash reconciliation showed consistent \$50 shortages on weekends. Investigation suggested possible register manipulation by a specific staff member.
Risk Assessment	Medium – financial loss, potential fraud, internal control failure.
Applicable Policy IDs	BO-03, BO-04, SP-10, EH-10, CP-05
Immediate Actions	• Review CCTV footage for the identified staff. • Conduct surprise cash counts. • Suspend staff pending investigation. • Notify HR and legal.
Long-Term Preventive Actions	• Implement segregation of duties. • Use electronic POS with audit trails. • Regular rotation of cash handling staff. • Enhance internal audit frequency.
Related Documents	Cash Reconciliation Policy, Fraud Prevention Guidelines, Investigation Report
Keywords	cash discrepancy, fraud, register manipulation, internal controls, investigation

Case 012

Case ID	CP-2025-012
Priority	High
Affected Branch	Victoria
Departments Involved	Kitchen, PR, Legal, Management
Scenario	A customer posted on social media that they found a foreign object (plastic) in their salad, with photos. The post went viral.
Risk Assessment	High – reputational damage, potential lawsuit, decline in sales, regulatory scrutiny.
Applicable Policy IDs	CP-06, FS-12, EH-11, SP-11, BO-11
Immediate Actions	• Respond publicly with apology and investigation commitment. • Contact customer directly and offer remedy. • Review food prep processes and identify source. • Preserve evidence and document.
Long-Term Preventive Actions	• Implement metal/plastic detection in prep. • Enhance visual inspection protocols. • Train staff on quality checks. • Develop social media crisis plan.
Related Documents	Social Media Crisis Plan, Food Quality SOP, Customer Complaint Handling Guide
Keywords	foreign object, social media, customer complaint, quality control, crisis management